

A DECISION, NOT A PITCH

Build for the counter. **Not the marketplace.**

The operating-system model for established owner-led Nigerian and West African food businesses in one UK cluster.

DAILY TAKEAWAY	EVENT CATERING	ASSISTED SAAS
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READ Decision Two cohorts Economics Boundaries Evidence 90 days Sou

01 — THE DECISION

UK-first assisted vertical SaaS, deliberately narrow.

Sell a practical operating system to established, owner-led Nigerian and West African takeaways and caterers in one London cluster, where they already have recurring orders and meaningful volume. Keep the two cohorts' evidence separate. The target model—not the current payment implementation—makes the vendor the **seller, food business operator, merchant of record, payment recipient and fulfiller.**

Commercial starting point: £39/month core. Test 0.5% GTV and £79–£119 fixed plans concurrently. Charge at least £99 once for setup, pass card fees through

transparently, and test a £149–£199 monthly cap or fixed plan for high-volume merchants.

02 — TWO JOBS, ONE TRUSTED OPERATOR

Do not make a caterer pretend to be a takeaway.

THE DAILY COUNTER

Takeaway cohort

PROBLEMS TO SOLVE

- ✗ Phone, WhatsApp and walk-in orders lose context
- ✗ Kitchen handover is informal at busy peaks
- ✗ Repeat customers need a direct channel, not another marketplace fee

PILOT WORKFLOW

- ✓ Online ordering and direct customer records
- ✓ Live kitchen status and fulfilment handover
- ✓ Vendor-entered allergen information and trading-hour control

THE EVENT LEDGER

Catering cohort

PROBLEMS TO SOLVE

- ✗ Enquiries live across conversations and spreadsheets
- ✗ Deposits, headcounts and dietary requirements drift
- ✗ An event handover needs one source of truth

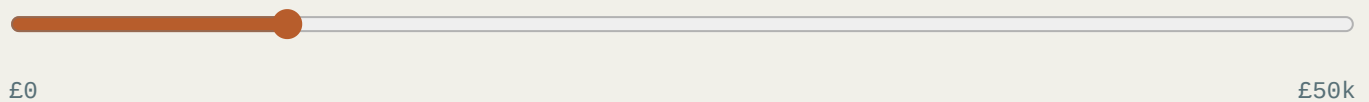
PILOT WORKFLOW

- ✓ Validate structured enquiry and quote capture
- ✓ Validate deposits and event status tracking
- ✓ Test date, menu, guest and allergen handover

A model that tells you what must become true.

This is a planning calculator, not a forecast. It keeps the variable-price test honest: revenue = £39 + 0.5% of GTV;
COGS = £9 + 0.1% of GTV.

MONTHLY GTV: £10,000



MONTHLY CONTRIBUTION TICKET			
REVENUE	COGS	CONTRIBUTION	CONTRIBUTION MARGIN
£89	£19	£70	79%
The COGS formula is a planning assumption for allocated hosting, notifications and routine support. It excludes card processing, acquisition, tax, central engineering and exceptional support.			

Be unusually clear about what the product does not do.

The credibility gain comes from giving operators a useful system without claiming an ecosystem. The first offer is SaaS and bounded assistance—not a substitute for legal, food-safety, payment or employment advice.

✓ We can support

Direct ordering and kitchen coordination

Catering workflows as a discovery track

Vendor-controlled menus and customer data

Configured onboarding within a clear cap

✗ We reject

Marketplace and commission dependency

Owned delivery and courier fleet

Merchant-of-record or pooled funds

Full POS, free SaaS, bespoke bundles, pan-Europe and super-app scope



Target boundary—not current payment capability: a documented connected-account charge flow must make the vendor the seller, merchant of record and payment recipient. The vendor sets prices, controls recipes and allergen accuracy, and fulfils directly or through its own courier; J'Toye invoices software separately. The current platform-account flow must not receive or settle funds for multiple vendors until the architecture, contracts and specialist review are complete.

Food-information and privacy boundary: distance sellers must provide allergen information before purchase and again on delivery; PPDS rules apply only to food prepacked for direct sale. Customer allergy requirements may reveal health information, so collection needs an appropriate Article 9 condition, clear notice, restricted access and short retention.

Do not claim: production or enterprise readiness; guaranteed food-safety, Natasha's Law or GDPR compliance; HMRC accounting; payouts, wallets or escrow; offline KDS or ticket printing; general AI WhatsApp commerce; proven disaster recovery; self-service tenancy; or pan-European support.

What we know, what we infer, what we must earn.

Confidence labels distinguish external constraints from commercial hypotheses. Filter them before making a claim.

High

The first cluster should be narrow, not pan-European

Start UK-first with established owner-led Nigerian and West African takeaways and caterers in one serviceable cluster. Shared menus, allergen-information requests, events and repeat customers make a useful vertical wedge.

Working assumption

Takeaway and catering have different buying moments

Takeaways need a reliable daily order and kitchen flow; caterers need enquiries, deposits, date capacity and event handover. One account can support both, but neither journey should be flattened into the other.

Working assumption

£39 core can be the uncomplicated entry point

A monthly core price is legible to established operators. Test it alongside a 0.5% GTV option or £79–£119 fixed packages, with a £99 setup fee and a £149–£199 capped or fixed option for high-volume merchants.

To validate

Assisted onboarding may beat a self-serve funnel

Menus, opening hours, dietary information and customer migration take care. Validate whether the setup fee pays for a repeatable, bounded onboarding service rather than bespoke consulting.

MODEL	DECISION	WHY
Assisted vertical SaaS	Recommended	Vendor retains the commercial relationship; J'Toye provides the operating system.
Marketplace	Reject	Would compete for the vendor's customer relationship and pull the model towards commission dependency.
Owned delivery	Reject	Introduces fleet utilisation, insurance and service-quality exposure outside the operating-system thesis.
Merchant of record / pooled funds	Reject	Adds payment, safeguarding and settlement obligations that are not needed to create the initial value.
Full POS or super-app	Reject	Broadens the product before the recurring order, catering and kitchen workflows have earned expansion.

06 — 90-DAY VALIDATION BOARD

Run a small test that can say no.

Recruit 30–40 qualified prospects and accept 10–12 paid pilots split across takeaway and catering. Continue only on measured behaviour—not enthusiasm.

ACTIVATION

At least 70% go live

Gate: At least 70% of paid pilots go live (7/10, 8/11 or 9/12), then at least 70% of live pilots activate menu, the agreed payment arrangement and a first real order; median assisted onboarding is no more than four hours.

Stop criterion: Stop if fewer than 5 of 30 qualified prospects pay or onboarding repeatedly becomes bespoke.

RETENTION

At least 80% stay paid

Gate: Steady support stays below 30 minutes per merchant each month and merchants evidence saved time, fewer errors, recovered deposits, lower waste or retained direct orders.

Stop criterion: Pivot if 90-day retention falls below 70%, support exceeds one hour, or use ends after setup and labels.

ECONOMICS

Contribution reaches £75+

Gate: CAC has a credible route below £375 with five-month payback.

Stop criterion: Reprice or stop if median direct sales remain below £8,000, merchants reject a higher fixed fee, or no economic outcome is demonstrated.

07 — SOURCES AND CAVEATS

Read the boundary before quoting the guide.

This guide is a dated strategic recommendation, not legal advice or market-size proof. Local operator interviews are intentionally a validation gate, not presented as completed evidence.

[Food Standards Agency — allergen guidance](#) 

[FCA — payment services and electronic money](#) 

[UK Finance — Payment Markets 2025](#) 

[ECB — SPACE 2024 payment study](#) 

[Jumia Food closure evidence](#) 

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